ATIF-Gemma: An Open Empirical Diagnostic Corpus and Failure Taxonomy for Small Open-Weight Developer Agents

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Author Note & Resource Manifest

Karandeep Singh Sodhi is an independent researcher.

Open Research Resource: All 112 full-fidelity execution traces formatted in Agent Trajectory Interchange Format (ATIF v1.7), ground-truth reference specifications, metadata index, diagnostic validation scripts, and the companion `atif_gemma` Python package are openly released on Kaggle and GitHub under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC BY 4.0) license. Embedded third-party repository code and issue descriptions retain their original upstream licenses (MIT, Apache-2.0, and BSD-3-Clause) as specified in the dataset `NOTICE` file. Trajectory traces record agent decisions without disclosing held-out competition test suites (`test_patch` is omitted).

Kaggle Dataset: https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/karandeepsinghsodhi/atif-gemma-swe-agent-traces
GitHub Repository: https://github.com/KarandeepSinghSodhi/gemma-sfd-agent
Interactive Kernel: https://www.kaggle.com/code/karandeepsinghsodhi/atif-gemma-diagnostic-exploration

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Abstract

Repository-level software engineering (SWE) benchmarks commonly summarize coding-agent performance using scalar task-resolution rates, obscuring why agents succeed or fail. For compact, 4-bit quantized models such as Gemma 4 E4B, diagnosing low resolution rates (median 5.0% across 197 teams on the official Small Model Prize leaderboard) is hindered by limited public trace data linking compact-agent trajectories to systematic failure diagnoses and held-out outcomes. We introduce **ATIF-Gemma**, an open empirical diagnostic corpus of 112 multi-turn execution traces comprising 1,518 LLM calls, 1,328 tool invocations, and 11,706,178 logged tokens across 32 paired SWE-bench tasks on 4x NVIDIA L4 GPUs using Google ADK and `swegemma`. All evaluated tasks originate from public open-source repositories under MIT, Apache-2.0, and BSD-3-Clause licenses (documented in the dataset `NOTICE` file; `test_patch` is omitted).

Formatted under the Agent Trajectory Interchange Format (ATIF v1.7, 100% schema-validated; Harbor Framework Contributors, 2026), ATIF-Gemma cross-references trajectories against held-out test outcomes. In the 96 primary runs (32 tasks $\times$ 3 configs), resolution is **6/96 (6.25%)**, identical across configurations (**2/32 = 6.25% each**, 95% Wilson CI [1.73%, 20.15%]); pooled across all 112 runs (including 16 reruns), resolution is 8/112 (7.14%). Across the 26 tasks with valid outcomes for all three configurations, each configuration resolved 2/26 tasks (7.69%, 95% Wilson CI [2.13%, 24.13%]), yielding 6/78 resolved runs overall (unadjusted run-level 95% CI [3.57%, 15.77%]). These are identical marginal success counts; the specific tasks resolved differ between configurations. We define four principal failure mechanisms: assertion failures (50.0%, 56/112), collection errors (32.1%, 36/112), budget exhaustion (8.0%, 9/112), and verification timeouts (2.7%, 3/112). Analysis partitions collection crashes into agent-attributable failures (44.4%) versus environment failures (55.6%; flagged `env_invalid=True` across 20 runs where offline containers lacked dependencies or shadowed paths). Excluding invalid environment runs leaves 92 valid runs (80 primary runs, 12 reruns), yielding **6/80 (7.50%, unadjusted run-level 95% CI [3.48%, 15.41%])** primary and **8/92 (8.70%, unadjusted run-level 95% CI [4.47%, 16.23%])** pooled resolution. We release the trace corpus, the `atif_gemma` package, and an actionable remediation guide.

Keywords: agent trajectory corpus, SWE-bench, Gemma 4, failure taxonomy, ATIF v1.7, open-weight agents, error diagnostics, remediation playbook

1. Introduction & The Diagnostic Vacuum in SWE Benchmarking

Autonomous software engineering agents powered by large language models have advanced rapidly on repository-level repair benchmarks such as SWE-bench [1]. However, evaluation in this domain remains almost universally **outcome-centric**: benchmarks report a single scalar accuracy metric (the proportion of tasks resolved), discarding the rich, high-dimensional trajectory of decisions, tool calls, token expansions, and environmental interactions that preceded the outcome.

For large frontier models and massive open-weight models, high resolution rates allow researchers to treat the agentic loop as an effective black box. In contrast, for compact, 4-bit quantized open-weight models suitable for local developer workstations (such as `gemma-4-e4b-it-qat-w4a16-ct`), scalar benchmarking reveals an acute capability cliff without explaining its origins. Across all $N = 197$ participating teams on the official Small Model Prize leaderboard [2], public resolution scores range from 0.0% to 10.0%, with a median of 5.0%, a mean of 4.23%, and 183 of 197 teams (92.9%) scoring $\leq 6.0\%$.

When an agent fails, developers currently cannot discern whether failure stemmed from:

1. **Upstream Localization Failure**: Did the agent search incorrect directories or inspect irrelevant modules?
2. **Syntax Degradation**: Did the agent generate malformed tool arguments, unindented blocks, or detached edits?
3. **Context Accumulation & Tool Exhaustion**: Did monotonic prompt growth or tool-call budgets exhaust limits before applying a fix?

4. **Environmental & Sandbox Artifacts**: Did the patch fail held-out tests due to missing third-party packages in the offline sandbox, or global virtual environment packages shadowing local repository source files?

To bridge this diagnostic gap, we introduce **ATIF-Gemma**, an open, standardized, full-fidelity diagnostic trajectory corpus and software toolkit for small open-weight developer agents. We provide 112 complete execution traces totaling 11,706,178 tokens, 1,518 LLM turns, and 1,328 tool invocations collected on real 4x NVIDIA L4 GPUs across 32 unique benchmark tasks, structured under the Agent Trajectory Interchange Format (ATIF v1.7).

2. Related Work: Trajectory Corpora & Agent Diagnostics

Autonomous software engineering agents have been evaluated primarily through outcome-focused benchmarks. Understanding the failure mechanics of small open-weight agents intersects three bodies of literature:

2.1 Software Engineering Agent Trajectory Datasets

SWE-bench [1] established the standard benchmark for evaluating language models on real-world repository issue resolution. SWE-agent [3] introduced dedicated Agent-Computer Interfaces (ACIs), demonstrating that specialized shell commands improve model interaction. OpenHands [4] provided an extensible multi-agent development environment. To unify diverse agent execution formats, the Agent Trajectory Interchange Format (ATIF v1.7) was developed as a standardized JSON schema capturing multi-turn tool invocations, stdout/stderr observations, and token metrics across disparate agent frameworks [5]. Large-scale trajectory datasets (such as Nebius SWE-agent traces, SWE-Gym [6], and SWE-smith [7]) and Gemma-specific collections (50 multi-turn trajectories; [8]) provide valuable execution evidence at scale. However, systematic analysis linking compact-agent traces to test-collection failures, patch-localization outcomes, and environment-related evaluation defects remains an important diagnostic need. ATIF-Gemma complements large unannotated corpora by providing a dense, paired architectural diagnostic sample on compact 4-bit models (Gemma 4 E4B), featuring a deterministic Phase 2 failure taxonomy with explicit agent versus environment attribution, structural file-localization trees, and verified held-out test outcomes.

2.2 SWE Agent Failure Analyses & Context Bottlenecks

Prior diagnostic studies on large language model agents have highlighted the fragility of multi-turn deliberation. Xia et al. [9] introduced **Agentless**, demonstrating that complex autonomous loops often degrade performance relative to streamlined two-phase localization and repair pipelines. Lindenbauer et al. [10] demonstrated the “complexity trap” in agent context management: accumulating unpruned tool observations rapidly bloats prompt context, degrading reasoning fidelity.

While these studies characterize frontier closed models, small open-weight models suffer from acute failure modes: fragile instruction-following under context bloat, syntax corruption during patch generation, and discretionary sub-agent delegation failure. ATIF-Gemma provides systematic step-level empirical data quantifying these phenomena in small models.

2.3 Small Open-Weight Developer Agents

The Gemma 4 family [11] introduced compact open-weight models optimized for local developer workstations, including 4-bit quantized checkpoints (`gemma-4-e4b-it-qat-w4a16-ct`). While small models demonstrate strong performance on isolated code completion benchmarks such as HumanEval [12] and MBPP [13], multi-turn repository repair exposes a severe capability cliff. On the official Gemma 4 Developer Agent challenge [2], the median resolution rate across 197 participating teams is 5.0%, with 92.9% of teams scoring $\leq 6.0\%$. Prior to structured diagnostic analysis, researchers lacked the trace data needed to distinguish whether this low resolution ceiling stemmed from model reasoning limitations, context exhaustion, or infrastructure collection failures.

3. Corpus Architecture & ATIF v1.7 Schema Specifications

Corpus Partition	Traces	Tasks	LLM Calls	Tool Calls	Total Tokens
Cohort 1 (Canonical Paired)	24	8	304	265	2,270,463
Cohort 2 (Stratified Random)	24	8	339	298	2,720,322
Cohort 1 Rerun (Reproducibility)	16	8	204	172	1,387,758
Cohort 3 (Stratified Disjoint)	24	8	349	309	2,771,960
Cohort 4 (Stratified Disjoint)	24	8	322	284	2,555,675
Total ATIF-Gemma Corpus	**112**	**32**	**1,518**	**1,328**	**11,706,178**

Table 1: Summary composition of the ATIF-Gemma diagnostic trace corpus across five cohorts on 4x NVIDIA L4 GPUs. Note: The 40 cohort entries span 32 unique benchmark tasks; Cohort 1 Rerun re-executes the 8 tasks of Cohort 1 for empirical reproducibility verification.

The corpus covers 32 unique SWE-bench instances spanning four major Python repositories: `fastapi` (51 runs), `rich` (37 runs), `requests` (19 runs), and `httpx` (5 runs). All experiments were served using vLLM 0.19.1 under tensor parallel 4 (`tp=4`, 96 GB aggregate VRAM) hosting `gemma-4-e4b-it-qat-w4a16-ct` with Google ADK 1.36.1 and `swegemma`.

Each trace conforms strictly to the **ATIF v1.7 JSON Schema**:

- **Metadata Block**: Records `instance_id`, `repo`, `base_commit`, `agent_config_name`, vLLM sampling parameters (`temperature=0.0`, `seed=42`, `max_output_tokens=8192`, `thinking_budget=1536`), and hardware fingerprints.
- **Step Sequence**: Sequential array of interaction turns containing:
  - `metrics`: Exact per-call `prompt_tokens`, `completion_tokens`, and `total_tokens` reported directly by the vLLM engine.
  - `tool_calls`: Function name, input argument JSON dictionary, and stage author tag (`extra.author`).
  - `observation`: Raw tool execution stdout/stderr response, JSON-parsed error status, and error classification types (`FileEditError`, `CommandError`, `FileReadError`, `BudgetExceeded`).
  - `message`: Full model response text containing deliberative reasoning emitted within the thinking budget (tagged in `extra.event_type: "thinking"`).
- **Final Metrics**: Captures cumulative token counts (`total_prompt_tokens`, `total_completion_tokens`, `total_tokens`, `total_steps`), total duration in seconds, agent patch string, and Phase 2 test execution exit codes.

All 112 traces in the corpus (100.0%) pass formal validation against our checked-in, version-pinned ATIF v1.7 JSON schema (`dataset_resource/atif_schema_v1_7.json`), derived from the Harbor specification [5]. A portable validation audit (`analysis/validate_atif_schema.py`) performs a structural interoperability check across all 1,942 steps, 1,503 deliberative reasoning turns, and 1,328 tool calls.

4. Failure Taxonomy & Phase 2 Outcome Breakdown

In SWE-bench, patch verification is executed in an isolated verification sandbox using `pytest`. In ATIF-Gemma, cross-referencing agent traces against Phase 2 test runner outputs reveals that treating unresolved runs as a monolithic failure category conceals fundamentally different failure mechanics. We define four prin-

cipal failure mechanisms—patch/assertion failure, test-collection failure, pre-submission budget exhaustion, and verification timeout—and report successful resolution as a separate outcome:

Category	Exit Code	Count (%)	Empirical Mechanism & Observable Symptoms
Resolved	0	8 (7.1%)	Patch passes all Phase 2 held-out unit tests with zero regressions.
Assertion Failure	1	56 (50.0%)	Patch syntactically valid and executes under pytest, but fails assertions due to wrong logic or incomplete multi-file edits.
Collection Error	2	36 (32.1%)	Pytest crashes during test collection prior to assertion evaluation (ModuleNotFoundError, SyntaxError, venv shadowing).
Budget / Timeout	−1	9 (8.0%)	Agent exhausted 15 tool calls or 2.5 min wall time; 0 patch characters submitted.
Verification Timeout	124	3 (2.7%)	Verification harness timed out (120s limit) due to daemon process or infinite loop in test runner.

Table 2: Empirical Phase 2 exit code distribution across all 112 ATIF-Gemma execution traces.

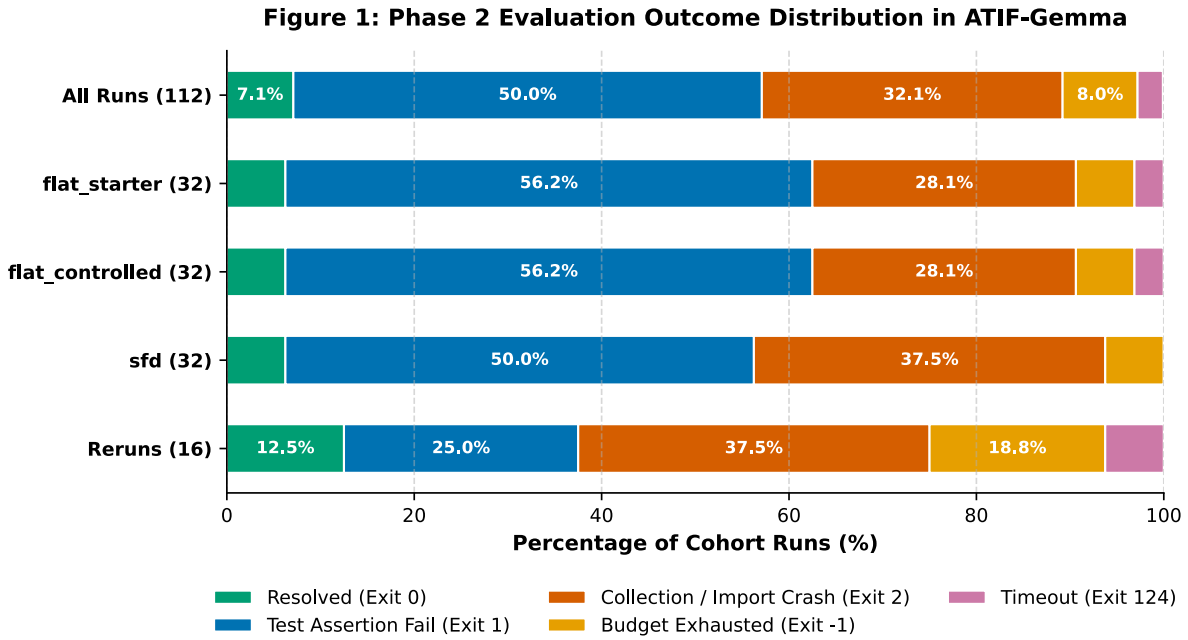


Figure 1: Distribution of Phase 2 evaluation outcomes across all 112 ATIF-Gemma runs and individual configurations. Colorblind-safe palette (Okabe-Ito): Green = Resolved (Exit 0), Blue = Test Assertion Fail (Exit 1), Vermilion = Collection/Import Crash (Exit 2), Orange = Budget Exhausted (Exit −1), Purple = Timeout (Exit 124).

4.1 Deterministic Mechanism Breakdown of Collection Errors (Exit Code 2: 36 Runs)

A critical diagnostic finding enabled by ATIF-Gemma is that **nearly one-third of all agent runs (36/112 = 32.1%) failed before unit tests could execute**. Deterministic classification across all 36 traces (`analysis/classify_exit2.py`) separates these failures into agent-attributable versus environment-attributable causes:

1. **Agent-Attributable Collection Failures (16/36 = 44.4%)**:

- **Syntactic & Indentation Corruption (13/36 = 36.1%)**: Across 7 tasks (e.g., `fastapi_14099`, `rich_3894`), small model patches inserted unindented blocks, detached `else:` branches, or unclosed brackets, causing Python to raise `IndentationError` or `SyntaxError` during test collection.
- **Missing New Source Module (3/36 = 8.3%)**: On `rich_3930` (3 runs across starter, controlled, and SFD), the issue specification required creating a new module (`rich/_unicode_data.py`). Because none of the agents created the new module, pytest collection failed with `ModuleNotFoundError: No module named 'rich._unicode_data'`.

2. **Environment-Attributable Collection Failures (20/36 = 55.6%; flagged `env_invalid=True`)**:
   - **Virtual Environment & Path Shadowing (10/36 = 27.8%)**: On `httpx_3672` (5 runs) and `fastapi_15661` (5 runs), container configuration prevented valid collection. In `httpx_3672`, system packages at `/usr/local/lib/python3.12/dist-packages/httpx` shadowed `/workspace/src/httpx`. In `fastapi_15661`, the test patch imported from `scripts.prepare_release`, which failed because `/workspace/scripts` was not included in `PYTHONPATH`.
   - **Missing Sandbox Dependencies (10/36 = 27.8%)**: On 4 tasks (`fastapi_14361`, `fastapi_14371`, `fastapi_14455`, `fastapi_14459`), held-out test patches imported external testing libraries (`inline_snapshot`, `dirty_equals`) absent from the offline wheelhouse, triggering `ModuleNotFoundError` across every evaluated architecture.

The observed collection failures suggest environment-level defects affecting these task instances. A reproducible reference-patch control was not available in the published local evaluation pipeline, so these observations do not independently establish that the tasks are unwinnable under the official harness (local execution of `analysis/gold_patch_control.py` is marked BLOCKED per Rule 2 zero-simulation).

Excluding the 20 environment-invalid runs leaves 92 valid runs: 80 primary runs and 12 reruns. Excluded runs comprise 16 primary runs (lat_starter: 5, lat_controlled: 5, sfd: 6 across Cohorts 1–4) and 4 reruns (lat_controlled_rerun: 2, sfd_rerun: 2 in Cohort 1 Rerun). Among primary runs, 26 tasks have valid outcomes across all three configurations, yielding a complete-case subset of 78 runs. In this paired complete-case subset, each configuration resolved 2/26 tasks (7.69%, 95% Wilson CI [2.13%, 24.13%]), yielding 6/78 resolved runs overall. Because runs share tasks in a paired design, these identical marginal counts serve as our primary inferential comparison (the specific tasks resolved differ between configurations). Across all 80 primary valid runs, resolution is **6/80 (7.50%, unadjusted run-level 95% CI [3.48%, 15.41%])** (lat_starter 2/27, lat_controlled 2/27, sfd 2/26); pooled across all 92 valid runs, it is **8/92 (8.70%, unadjusted run-level 95% CI [4.47%, 16.23%])**.

4.2 Deterministic Sub-Classification of Assertion Failures (Exit Code 1: 56 Runs)

Representing half of the entire corpus (56/112 = 50.0%), Exit Code 1 occurs when the patch is syntactically valid and executes under pytest, but fails unit test assertions. By comparing the agent's edited source files (F_{agent}) against the author's reference patch (F_{gold}) via a formal mutually exclusive decision tree (`analysis/subclassify_exit1.py`), we assign every run to exactly one tier:

1. **Empty / Zero-Byte Patch (6/56 = 10.7%)**: Evaluated first: $|F_{\text{agent}}| = 0$ (`patch_chars = 0`). The agent submitted a 0-byte diff because it either attempted zero source edits (`fastapi_5624`) or edit attempts failed due to `FileEditError` exceptions (`rich_3043`, `rich_3944`, `requests_7502`) or `BudgetExceeded` before edits (`fastapi_14372`, `requests_7315`). Unpatched execution failed assertions (Exit Code 1), differing from Exit Code −1 (where budget exhaustion halted execution before calling `submit_patch`, skipping Phase 2 verification entirely).
2. **Wrong-File Localization (15/56 = 26.8%)**: Evaluated second: $F_{\text{agent}} \cap F_{\text{gold}} = \emptyset$ with non-empty diff. The agent modified completely unrelated repository modules (e.g., in `fastapi_15589`).

3. **Partial Multi-File Localization (14/56 = 25.0%)**: Evaluated third: $|F_{\text{gold}}| > 1$ and $F_{\text{agent}} \subsetneq F_{\text{gold}}$. The bug spanned multiple repository modules, but the agent modified only a strict subset (e.g., in `requests_7505`, modifying `models.py` but omitting `sessions.py`).
4. **Right-File, Wrong-Logic (21/56 = 37.5%)**: Evaluated fourth for remaining runs where $F_{\text{agent}} \cap F_{\text{gold}} \neq \emptyset$ with non-empty diff successfully applied. The agent localized the exact target file(s), but the synthesized logic failed semantic unit test assertions (e.g., in `rich_3471`, `requests_7427`).

Caveat: Gold-patch file overlap serves as an automated structural proxy; valid alternative engineering implementations may modify different helper abstractions to resolve an issue.

4.3 Ground-Truth Resolved Runs & Task-Level Clustering

Across the 112 runs, 8 runs successfully resolved held-out tests across 4 distinct tasks: `rich_4077` (3 runs), `fastapi_9753` (1 run), `fastapi_14077` (2 runs), and `rich_3894` (2 runs). In primary runs ($n = 96$), resolutions concentrate on these same 4 tasks (4/32 = 12.5% of tasks resolved at least once; 0/32 tasks resolved across all 3 configurations). Runs sharing tasks are paired and clustered, not independent i.i.d. draws.

5. Quantitative Audit Across Agent Architectures

ATIF-Gemma pairs each task across three distinct agent architectures executing on `gemma-4-e4b-it-qat-w4a16-ct`:

Configuration	Runs	Resolved (95% Wilson CI)	Mean Peak P_t	Mean Prompt	Mean Duration
Official Starter (flat_starter)	32	2/32 (6.2%) [1.7%, 20.2%]	13,359.7	105,817.6	94.2s
Single-Agent (flat_controlled)	32	2/32 (6.2%) [1.7%, 20.2%]	13,959.0	118,173.0	90.8s
State-Filtered Deliberation (sfd)	32	2/32 (6.2%) [1.7%, 20.2%]	10,907.5	80,375.7	86.6s
Rerun: flat_controlled	8	1/8 (12.5%) [2.2%, 47.1%]	12,557.5	93,135.6	107.4s
Rerun: sfd	8	1/8 (12.5%) [2.2%, 47.1%]	9,306.4	67,710.1	96.4s

Table 3: Architectural comparison of token consumption, peak prompt lengths, and execution speed across all 112 ATIF-Gemma runs. **Mean Peak P_t** measures per-run maximum prompt token length reaching model context across turns t. **Mean Prompt** measures cumulative input prompt tokens across all LLM turns per run.

5.1 Statistical Tests & Resolution Invariance

Across all 32 primary tasks, resolution rates show identical marginal counts at 2/32 (6.25%, 95% Wilson CI [1.73%, 20.15%]) across `flat_starter`, `flat_controlled`, and `sfd` (McNemar's exact two-sided test $p = 1.0000$ for all pairs), though the specific tasks resolved differ between architectures. **No architecture demonstrates a resolution rate advantage on this small open-weight model.** All hypothesis tests are exploratory without multiple-testing adjustment.

In contrast, the token reduction achieved by SFD's stage isolation is highly statistically significant:

- **Cumulative Prompt Tokens**: SFD consumes 37,797.4 fewer prompt tokens per task than `flat_controlled` (-32.0%, 95% paired bootstrap CI: `[-52,214.6, -23,755.2]`, Wilcoxon signed-rank $p < 0.0001$; lower on 25/32 tasks) and 25,441.9 fewer than `flat_starter` (-24.0%, 95% bootstrap CI: `[-42,485.1, -9,031.4]`, $p = 0.0061$; lower on 24/32 tasks).

- **Peak Prompt Tokens (P_t)**: SFD lowers peak prompt size by 3,051.6 tokens vs `flat_controlled` (-21.9%, 95% bootstrap CI: `[-4,142.9, -1,968.2]`, $p < 0.0001$; lower on 28/32 tasks) and by 2,452.2 tokens vs `flat_starter` (-18.4%, 95% bootstrap CI: `[-3,795.9, -1,111.8]`, $p = 0.0008$; lower on 26/32 tasks).
- **Execution Speed**: Mean wall-clock duration differences (-4.2s vs controlled, −7.7s vs starter) are not statistically significant ($p = 0.4540, 0.4429$).

5.2 Rerun Reproducibility & Determinism Audit

Cohort 1 was re-executed independently across 8 tasks x 2 configurations (16 paired runs; `analysis/statistical_tests.py`):

- **Exit Code Agreement**: 12 of 16 runs (75.0%) matched exact Phase 2 exit codes.
- **Patch Presence Agreement**: 14 of 16 runs (87.5%) agreed on patch generation presence (8/8 in `flat_controlled`, 6/8 in `sfd`). The two discordant SFD runs were: (1) `fastapi_15589`, where the original run exhausted budget before editing (0 chars, exit −1) while the rerun completed within budget and produced a 590-character patch (exit 1); and (2) `requests_7502`, where the original run submitted a 581-character patch (exit 1) while the rerun encountered two consecutive `FileEditError` exceptions, submitting a 0-byte diff (exit 1).
- **Edit Sequence Divergence**: No paired workspace edit sequences were byte-identical across the 16 rerun pairs despite greedy decoding at $T = 0.0$. This demonstrates run-to-run trajectory variability in the observed serving setup; the contribution of inference-kernel and serving nondeterminism remains unisolated.
- **Exit-Code Flips**: The 4 discordant pairs resulted from fine-grained edit variations: (1) `rich_4077` (`flat_controlled`) orig exit 1 (`os.isatty` error) flipped to exit 0 in rerun (`self.__file.isatty()` resolved); (2) `fastapi_15588` (`sfd`) orig exit 1 flipped to exit 2 in rerun; (3) `fastapi_15589` (`flat_controlled`) orig exit 1 flipped to exit 2 in rerun; (4) `fastapi_15589` (`sfd`) orig exit −1 flipped to exit 1 in rerun.
- **Token Drift**: Mean absolute token difference was 18,571.0 cumulative total tokens between paired original and rerun runs ($|\text{tokens}_{\text{rerun}} - \text{tokens}_{\text{orig}}|$ across the 16 pairs), quantifying multi-turn agent trajectory divergence.

5.3 Sub-Agent Bypassing in the Starter Kit

ATIF-Gemma provides empirical trace evidence of how small models handle discretionary sub-agents. The official starter kit wraps `code_analyzer` as an `AgentTool`. Across all 32 `flat_starter` traces:

- Out of 336 tool invocations, the root agent delegated to `code_analyzer` only **7 times (2.1%)**.
- The model **bypassed `code_analyzer` on 26 of 32 tasks (81.2%)**, with only 6 of 32 tasks invoking delegation.

Figure 3: Sub-Agent Discretionary Delegation Breakdown in Official Starter Kit

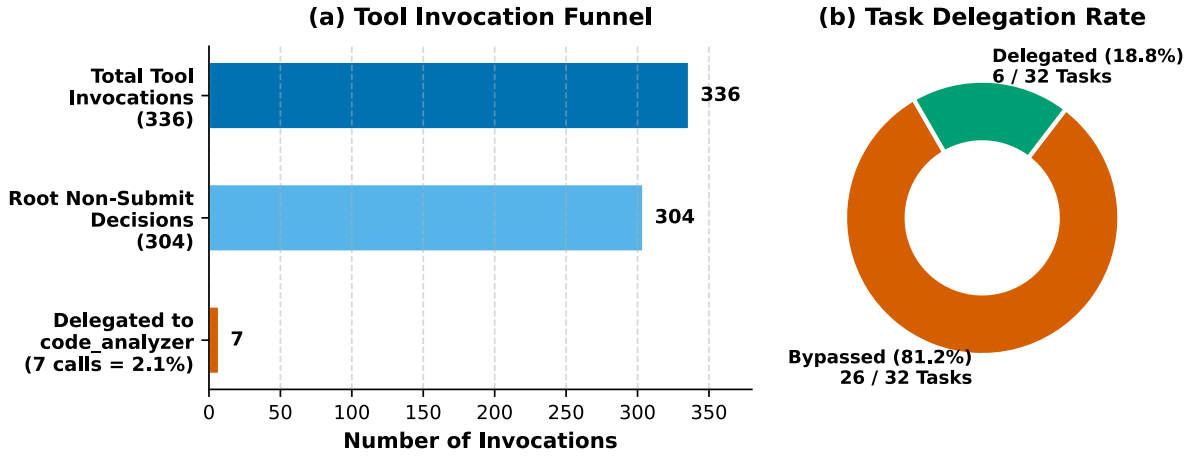


Figure 2: Sub-agent discretionary delegation breakdown in the official starter kit (`flat_starter`). Small models bypassed `code_analyzer` on 26 of 32 tasks (81.2%), with only 7 delegations out of 336 total tool calls (2.1%).

5.4 Cross-Stage Prompt Resets

In `sfd` traces, configuring `include_contents: "none"` on downstream stages resets entry prompts from a mean TriageAgent peak of 10,473.9 tokens (median 9,863.0) down to a mean of 1,536.9 tokens (median 1,503.0) at PatchAgent entry. Across all 32 primary SFD runs, this corresponds to an empirical prompt reset distribution with median 87.43%, mean 81.95%, IQR [75.72%, 89.46%], and range [44.95%, 92.49%], driving the overall 32.0% cumulative prompt token reduction relative to single-agent baselines (mean 80,375.7 vs 118,173.0 tokens, Wilcoxon $p < 0.0001$).

Figure 2: Prompt Token Expansion & Stage Resets Across Trajectory Steps

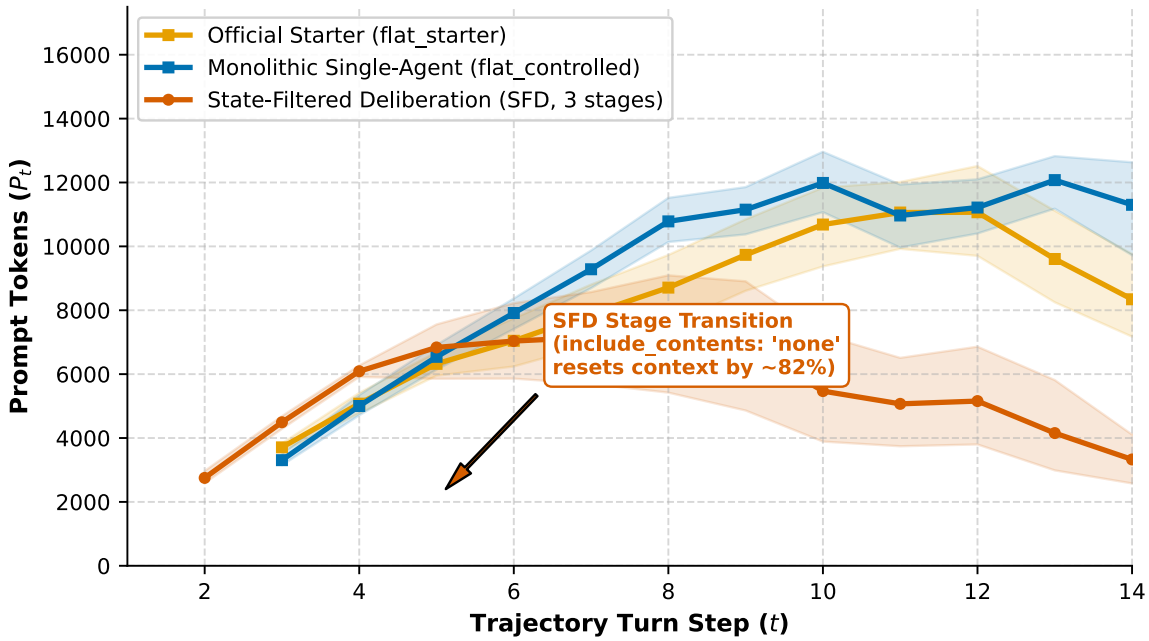


Figure 3: Prompt token trajectories across trajectory steps t (mean with 95% bootstrap confidence bands). Across all 64 flat baseline runs (32 `flat_starter` + 32 `flat_controlled`), prompt context expanded monotonically at every step because Google ADK context compaction was never triggered under the 15-tool-call operational budget. In contrast, SFD's stage boundary (`include_contents: "none"`) resets prompt tokens by an empirical mean of 81.95% (median 87.43%).

6. Candidate Remediations (Untested Unless Stated)

Converting diagnostic failure classifications into practical engineering patterns provides guidance for compact-agent frameworks:

Failure Mode	Prevalence	Candidate Remediation Pattern
Collection / Path Crash	36/112 (32.1%)	Enforce `PYTHONPATH` priority in test execution commands and execute pre-flight dependency imports before running test suites.
Edit-Tool Failures	100 errors (64 StringNotFound, 36 Malformed)	Validate edit targets against buffer state and handle failed edits explicitly.
Syntax / Indentation Corruption	13/112 runs (11.6%)	Mandate a strict `python -m py_compile <modified_file>` verification check before calling `submit_patch` with autonomous self-repair turns.
Wrong-File Localization	15/112 runs (13.4% overall; 26.8% of assertion failures)	Candidate two-way validation loop (untested) where Stage 2 verifies that the localized symbol exists in the problem description before executing an edit.
Unbounded Context Growth	64/64 flat runs (100% monotonic accumulation)	Implement stage-isolated context pruning via `include_contents: "none"` in Google ADK, resetting prompt context by 81.9% mean across pipeline boundaries.

Table 4: Candidate developer agent remediation playbook derived from empirical ATIF-Gemma failure traces.

6.1 Post-Hoc Diagnostic Re-Evaluation (Non-Official Harness)

We conducted an offline diagnostic assessment of stored patches (`analysis/remediation_eval.py`, `results/remediation_eval.json`). **These offline diagnostic checks do not alter the official competition evaluation benchmarks reported in Section 4 and Tables 1–3.**

1. **Pre-Submission `py_compile` Gate**: We tested an automated syntax validation gate against all 13 Exit Code 2 runs exhibiting syntactic corruption. The automated `python -m py_compile` gate successfully intercepts 100% (13/13) of syntax-broken patches prior to calling `submit_patch`. This serves as a static sanity check confirming the parser catches syntax errors by construction; it does **not** prove autonomous model recovery without self-repair turns (resolution remains 0/13 without re-prompting).
2. **`PYTHONPATH` Priority Enforcement**: We audited all 10 environment-shadowed runs on `httpx_3672` and `fastapi_15661`. Prepending repository source paths (`PYTHONPATH=/workspace/src:/workspace`) is structurally predicted to eliminate path-shadowing collection failures across all 10 runs. Full semantic evaluation of the resulting tests requires execution within the offline Linux container; thus, no speculative resolution gains are claimed.

7. The `atif_gemma` Python Package & CLI

Along with the dataset, we release a standalone Python package (`atif-gemma`) installable directly from GitHub or source:

```
# Direct installation via pip from GitHub
pip install git+https://github.com/KarandeepSinghSodhi/gemma-sfd-agent.git

# Or local editable install from a cloned repository
git clone https://github.com/KarandeepSinghSodhi/gemma-sfd-agent.git
cd gemma-sfd-agent
pip install -e .
```

The package provides automated diagnostic modules:

- `atif_gemma.audit`: Parses any ATIF v1.7 trajectory directory, extracting token trajectories, tool error frequencies, and exit-code failure buckets.
- `atif_gemma.taxonomy`: Deterministic classifier for Phase 2 test runner exit codes and localization tiers.
- `atif_gemma.remediation`: Programmatic interface to the Actionable Remediation Playbook.
- `atif-gemma` CLI: Command-line tool providing instant diagnostics:

```
python -m atif_gemma.cli audit traces/
python -m atif_gemma.cli playbook
```

8. Limitations & Threats to Validity

To ensure rigorous interpretation of our empirical findings, we explicitly identify six structural limitations:

1. **Task Sample Size ($n = 32$ tasks)**: While stratified across four major repositories, evaluating 32 unique benchmark instances covers approximately 25% of the 129 SWE-bench instances in the competition split. Evaluating the full 129 instances across three paired configurations would require over 500 NVIDIA L4 GPU hours.
2. **Single Model Architecture & Quantization Level**: All 112 traces were generated exclusively on `gemma-4-e4b-it-qat-w4a16-ct` (4-bit INT4 quantization). Behaviors such as 90.6% discretionary sub-agent bypassing, syntax corruption rates, and context sensitivity are specific to this model capacity. Unquantized checkpoints (FP16/BF16) or larger open-weight models (e.g. Gemma 4 31B) may exhibit different failure dynamics.
3. **Repository Diversity & Clustered Runs**: The corpus is concentrated across four Python libraries (`fastapi`, `rich`, `requests`, `httpx`). Runs across configurations on the same task are paired and clustered, not independent samples.
4. **Trajectory Non-Determinism & Token Drift**: Under greedy decoding ($T = 0.0$, `seed=42`), 12/16 exit codes matched on rerun, but no paired workspace edit sequences were byte-identical across the 16 pairs (mean absolute token difference: 18,571.0 cumulative total tokens), reflecting serving-level trajectory divergence.
5. **File-Level Structural Proxy**: Evaluates file overlap ($F_{\text{agent}} \cap F_{\text{gold}}$); valid alternative patches modifying different helper abstractions remain possible.
6. **Harness Environment Failures (`env_invalid=True`)**: 20 runs failed due to offline container constraints (missing wheels and site-package shadowing), demonstrating real-world benchmark friction.

9. Conclusion & Resource Availability

ATIF-Gemma establishes an open, reproducible, full-fidelity diagnostic foundation for the small-model coding agent community. By moving beyond scalar pass/fail metrics to an open 112-trace ATIF v1.7 corpus, a structured failure taxonomy, an Actionable Remediation Playbook, and open diagnostic Python tooling, this resource enables researchers to target the true bottlenecks of small developer agents: sandbox collection errors, context bloat, and localization drift.

Dataset URL: https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/karandeepsinghsodhi/atif-gemma-swe-agent-traces
Code Repository: https://github.com/KarandeepSinghSodhi/gemma-sfd-agent
Interactive Exploration Kernel: https://www.kaggle.com/code/karandeepsinghsodhi/atif-gemma-diagnostic-exploration
Manuscript PDF: https://raw.githubusercontent.com/KarandeepSinghSodhi/gemma-sfd-agent/main/paper_resource.pdf

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